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Investment to boost nuclear capacity

Constellation to spend \$4.3B in Illinois, other states, then sell additional power to Google

By John Lippert and Finnegan Belleau
FOR THE CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Constellation Energy, the largest U.S. nuclear provider, agreed Tuesday to invest \$4.3 billion to increase output at 11 nuclear plants in Illinois, Pennsylvania and New Jersey, and then sell this additional power to Google over a 20-year period.

About half of Constellation's investment, or \$2 billion, will be spent at the Byron, Braidwood, LaSalle and Quad Cities plants in Illinois, according to Paul Adams, a Constellation spokesman.

Tuesday's agreement comes as Google and other artificial intelligence companies are building data centers at record rates, and as rising electricity rates driven by

this construction boom are helping spark a growing political backlash.

Google will fully pay for the additions in northern Illinois, a Constellation spokesperson wrote in an email to the Tribune.

"No costs from the deal will go to Illinois customers, and in fact, the additional supply resulting from Google's investment will exert downward pressure on energy rates for Illinois residents," the spokesperson wrote.

On Sept. 24, consultants for the Illinois Power Agency and other

state regulators said the installed capacity of the state's electricity grid will need to double by 2045 to 120 gigawatts, mainly to support data center growth.

Tuesday's agreement will boost output at the 11 Constellation nuclear plants by 890 megawatts, or about the size of a typical nuclear reactor in the U.S.

The announcement represents "responsible growth," Pat Devaney, secretary treasurer of Illinois AFL-CIO, said in a statement to the Tribune. The federation represents

almost 900,000 workers in Illinois, according to its website.

"Our members are ready to bring roughly 450 megawatts of new clean power online — the equivalent of two small modular reactors — at no cost to Illinois ratepayers," Devaney said in the statement. "It is proof positive that Illinois can invest in clean energy and create good-paying union jobs without passing on the costs."

Specifically, the additional

See **NUCLEAR** on Page A5



THEIR KIND OF TOWN

Sabrina, from left, Michelle and Rebecca, of New York City, take a selfie as they stand on the DuSable Bridge over the Chicago River in the Loop on Tuesday. On Tuesday, Conde Nast Traveler magazine named Chicago Best Big City in the U.S. for the 10th year in a row. **Business**

EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Border scene reminder of Israel attack

View of devastated Gaza puts Oct. 7 into perspective for many

By Cara Anna
ASSOCIATED PRESS

SDEROT, Israel — One by one, Israelis peered through the tourist-style binoculars at the shattered Gaza town of Beit Hanoun, a distance of several football fields away, where buildings tilted in the rubble like broken teeth. The only noticeable movement was dust kicked up by Israel's military.

The Israelis squinted for a few moments and gestured others over. The lookout is a rare place where they can confront the Palestinian territory firsthand, and some celebrate its devastation.

An Israeli documentary released this year included one onlooker exclaiming, "Wow, destroyed beautifully." The Associated Press heard similar sentiments there.

On Oct. 7, 2023, Hamas-led militants killed some 1,200 people in southern Israel and abducted 251 others, leading to a devastating war and, eventually, a fragile ceasefire.

Three years on, a visit to the communities attacked that day made clear: It's too soon for many residents to see the Palestinians as anything other than a threat.

The highway running parallel to Gaza, where militants gunned down people trying to flee, is dotted with

See **ISRAEL** on Page A2



Izidora Angel, a literary translator, in her home on Sept. 21. Angel recently translated the novel "She Who Remains" from Bulgarian into English, which was a finalist for an international award.

EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

The art of translation

Chicago's book translators 'inhabit' languages in their work

By Rebecca Johnson
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

For Izidora Angel, translating books from her native Bulgarian to English is akin to an actor reading a script.

She'll start by writing five or 10 pages in order to understand the author's voice — the cadence, the emotional beats. Then she's able to fully inhabit it.

"You have to find all the nooks and crannies of it ...

otherwise it's like hitting the (wrong) note on the piano," the 45-year-old Near West Side resident said. "It doesn't sound right and everyone can hear it."

Still, Angel felt an unusually intense connection with "She Who Remains." The novel, by Bulgarian author Rene Karabash, follows a young woman cloistered in a rural Albanian village who escapes an arranged marriage by becoming a "sworn virgin."

The book — and by extension

Angel — has been celebrated across the world this year as a finalist for the International Booker Prize, an influential literary award for translated fiction. It's even been recommended by Malala Yousafzai and Dua Lipa. In Chicago, she shares her talents with the Third Coast Translators Collective.

Around 30 people translating from over a dozen languages,

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ELECTION 2026 8TH DISTRICT

Bean seeks comeback vs. GOP newcomer

Ex-congresswoman vies for seat against Davis, who is running for first time

By Robert McCoppin
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Former U.S. Rep. Melissa Bean, a centrist Democrat whose 2004 upset helped begin the northwest suburbs' shift to the left, is seeking a comeback in Illinois' 8th Congressional District against Republican Jennifer Davis, a tech entrepreneur running for office for the first time.

The two are vying in the Nov. 3 general election to succeed Democratic U.S. Rep. Raja Krishnamoorthi, who gave up the seat as part of his unsuccessful bid for the U.S. Senate this year. He has endorsed Bean.

A former three-term congresswoman, Bean said she is returning to politics to restore democracy, healthcare and the economy. Davis said she is running to cut red tape, help small businesses and support families with what she describes as commonsense solutions. Christopher Krumpac, an independent with a background in information technology, is running as a write-in candidate. A self-described moderate progressive, he supports "Medicare for All" and a ban on campaign donations from corporations and political action committees.

The largely middle-class district, drawn by Democrats in the last redistricting, roughly follows the Jane Addams Memorial Tollway from Des Plaines to the farmland beyond Elgin, then runs south along the Fox River to St. Charles and Geneva. The Cook Political Report rates the district solidly Democratic, noting it voted about 5 percentage points more Democratic than the nation as a whole in the last two presidential elections. Krishna-

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INSIDE

Sox soaking it all in ahead of Game 3



White Sox see a sunny forecast after years of gloom and doom. Plus, Sean Newcomb will start Game 3 in front of home crowd. **Sports**

Just a few days left to enter cookie contest

Time is running out, but you can still enter the Tribune's 40th annual Holiday Cookie Contest. Recipe submissions close at 11:59 p.m. Oct. 9. **Food & Health**

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